

Illustration

Urbanism >> City>>

Rejuvenation of Ramala Lake

Chandpur, India.

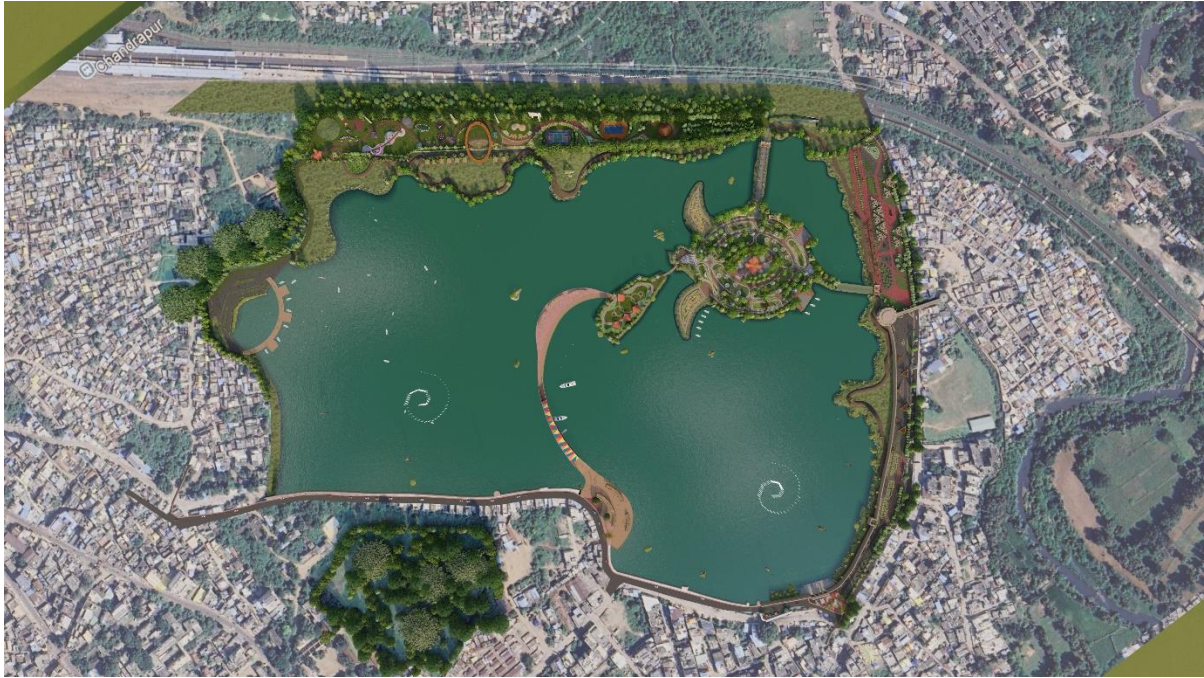
Use – Ecological Restoration & Public Recreation Hub

Typology – Urban

Size M2/Ft2 – 23200 / 2,49,725

Status – On-going

Reviving Waters, Reconnecting Lives



Introdcution

Located in **Chandrapur**, the lake serves as an important ecological and social asset within the urban fabric of the city. Historically functioning as a water body with environmental and cultural value, the lake today presents opportunities for revitalization through improved accessibility, ecological restoration, and landscape enhancement. The project recognizes the lake not as an isolated entity but as part of a larger urban ecosystem that influences climate response, biodiversity, public health, and community interaction. By strengthening physical and visual connections to the waterfront, the intervention transforms the site into a more accessible, active, and meaningful destination for residents and visitors.



Location & Site Opportunities

Located in the urban core of Chandrapur, the site consists of an existing lake surrounded by dense residential neighborhoods and important urban connections, making it a significant ecological and public asset for the city. Its strategic location offers the opportunity to transform the lake into an accessible and vibrant public destination while restoring its environmental value. The site supports ecological regeneration, improved public accessibility, recreational experiences, and stronger connections between people, nature, and the waterfront—creating a resilient and inclusive landscape that contributes to the identity and future growth of Chandrapur.



At a symbolic level, the overall spatial form takes inspiration from the turtle, representing stability, endurance, and harmony between land and water. The conceptual narrative further reflects the idea of Samudra Manthan, where water becomes a source of transformation, regeneration, and collective growth. References to the different Yugas—including Treta Yuga and Dwapar Yuga—express the continuity of time and evolving human relationships with natural systems, allowing the landscape to become both a contemporary public space and a cultural experience.



The design approach is rooted in Water Sensitive Urban Design (WSUD), where water becomes the central element shaping both the landscape and user experience. The proposal adopts the principles of Sponge Cities, enabling the site to absorb, retain, filter, and manage water naturally through ecological systems and resilient landscape infrastructure. These interventions contribute to groundwater recharge, improved water quality, flood mitigation, and long-term environmental sustainability.

The project further emphasizes the creation of meaningful public spaces through principles of placemaking, focusing on accessibility, activity, comfort, inclusivity, and social interaction. The rejuvenated lakefront introduces spaces for recreation, gathering, movement, contemplation, and engagement, encouraging people to reconnect with both nature and community. Through these interventions, the lake is transformed into a vibrant and resilient public landscape that supports ecological restoration while enhancing everyday urban life.



The rejuvenation of Chandrapur Lake is envisioned as more than an environmental intervention—it is a process of restoring identity, strengthening ecological systems, and creating meaningful public experiences. By combining water-sensitive planning, ecological regeneration, inclusive accessibility, and culturally rooted place-making, the project establishes a new relationship between urban life and natural landscapes. The vision is to create a destination where water is not only conserved but celebrated—an adaptive, vibrant, and resilient public realm designed for present and future generations.

